

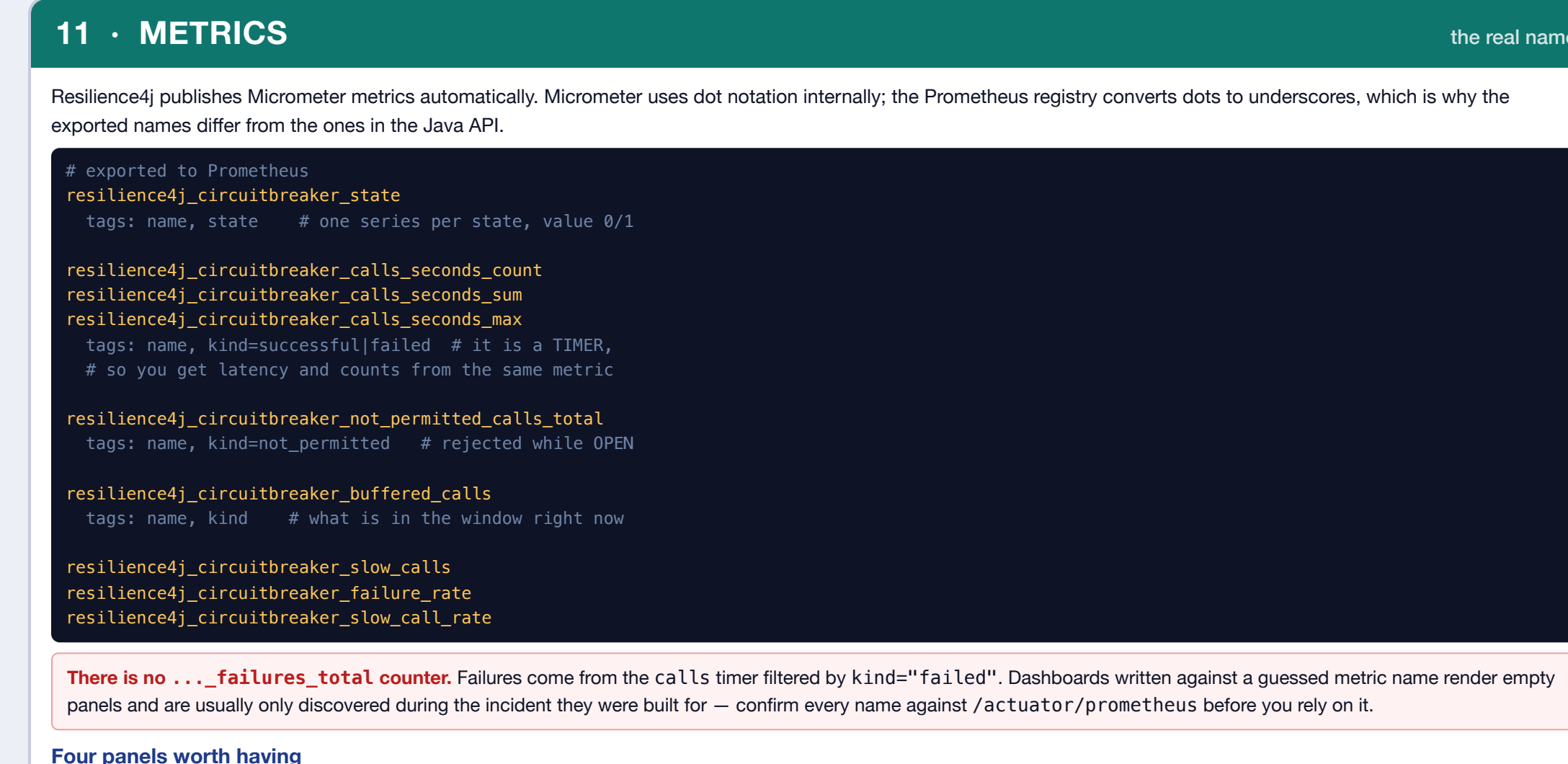
start here — the failure it prevents, before the configuration

- **Why a timeout alone is not enough**
 - **A timeout still costs you the wait.** A 3-second timeout on a dead dependency means every request burns a thread for 3 seconds before failing. At scale that is still pool exhaustion, just slower.
 - **It has no memory.** The thousandth request pays the full timeout exactly like the first, even though the previous 999 all failed.
 - **It keeps hammering** a service that is trying to recover.

six states, not three - the circuit opens on a rate, never on a count - and the decorator order is fixed unless you change



what to return



it is untested until you have opened i



confirm before a breaker sits between your service and a dependency that pays the bill.

